



Lab: Create a Stakeholder Engagement Plan

Estimated duration: 30-40 minutes

Learning Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- 1. Analyze stakeholder behaviors and traits to assess Power and Interest levels.
- 2. Identify communication styles and determine current versus desired commitment levels.
- 3. Develop engagement strategies to build stronger relationships and secure stakeholder commitment.
- 4. Create a comprehensive Stakeholder Engagement Plan using the provided template.

Scenario

You are the **Supply Chain Manager** for *Pacific Precision Manufacturing (PPM)*, a company producing precision-engineered parts for the automotive and aerospace industries.

PPM has launched a **Supply Chain Digital Integration Project** to modernize operations with supplier dashboards, real-time tracking, and demand forecasting tools.

You collaborate with **seven external partners**, each with unique behaviors and influence on the project.

Your task is to complete a **Stakeholder Engagement Plan** that identifies each stakeholder's **Power**, **Interest**, **Communication Style**, **Current and Desired Commitment Levels**, and **Engagement Strategies** to align them with project goals.

Current Date: 1 April 20XX

Prerequisites

Before starting this lab, ensure you've completed the following learning assets:

- Reading: *Defining Communication Styles*
- Video: *Stakeholder Motivational Techniques and Application*
- Activity Dialogue: *Communications Planning and Different Communication Styles*
- Lab: *Assess Your Communication Style*

Stakeholder Information

Stakeholder	Role / Description	Observed Traits & Behaviors
1. Alpha Metals, Inc. (Raj Patel)	Major supplier of raw steel and aluminum. A key influencer.	Analytical, data-driven, requests metrics and reports. Cautiously supportive but concerned about implementation risks. Seeks results.
2. TransLogix Freight Services (Lisa Chen)	Long-haul transportation provider. A key influencer.	Relationship-oriented and collaborative. Worries about paperwork and time commitments. Not overly impacted by results.
3. AeroTech Components (James Miller)	Secondary supplier with small contracts. Minimal impact.	Engages only when prompted; prefers brief email updates. Little day-to-day interaction.
4. Quantum Packaging Solutions (Maria Gomez)	Small vendor for specialized packaging.	Creative and forward-thinking. Positive about innovation. High potential for future influence.
5. Velocity Transport Brokerage (Paul Singh)	Regional transport broker. High influence potential.	Resistant to change. Prefers manual processes. Skeptical of technology and integration efforts.
6. Global Sourcing Group (Helena Kim)	Strategic procurement partner. Critical partner.	Executive presence. Likes concise summaries and reliability. Holds significant influence. Relationship-focused and results-driven.
7. Pacific Auto Assembly (Bob Evans)	Major end customer.	High expectations for precision, quality, and delivery metrics. Monitors project results closely.

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. **Review the scenario and stakeholder traits carefully.**
Study each stakeholder's traits to understand their attitudes and influence.
2. **Download the Stakeholder Engagement Plan Excel Template.**
You'll use this file to document your analysis.
3. **For each stakeholder, complete the following fields:**
 - **Level of Power:** High or Low
 - **Level of Interest:** High or Low
 - **Preferred Communication Style:** Analytical, Structural, Conceptual, or Social
 - **Current Level of Commitment:** Unknown (U), Resistant (R), Neutral (N), Supportive (S), Leading (L)
 - **Desired Level of Commitment:** Your target engagement state

- **Primary Engagement Strategies:** Tactics to move stakeholders toward desired commitment

4. **Save your completed plan** and **compare it to the Book Solution** at the end of this exercise.

Note: Your responses may differ slightly from the provided solution — that's expected based on your interpretation.

Example Guidance and Hints

Communication Style Hints

- *Asks for data or reports* → **Analytical**
- *Prefers structure, deadlines, or checklists* → **Structural**
- *Enjoys brainstorming or creative discussions* → **Conceptual**
- *Values relationships, stories, and collaboration* → **Social**

Power Rating Hints

- **High Power:** Stakeholder can influence project success, funding, or strategic direction.
 - **Low Power:** Limited authority but might still impact adoption or reputation.
- 💡 *If a stakeholder can delay, approve, or redirect project outcomes, classify them as High Power.*

Interest Rating Hints

- **High Interest:** Directly impacted by project outcomes or changes.
 - **Low Interest:** Limited exposure or indirect impact.
- 💡 *If a stakeholder volunteers feedback or requests updates, they likely have High Interest.*

Commitment and Strategy Hints

- **Resistant** → Show early wins, provide training, and communicate clear benefits.
- **Neutral** → Involve in decision-making to increase buy-in.
- **Supportive** → Recognize contributions and involve in advocacy.

Reflection and Comparison

After completing your Stakeholder Engagement Plan:

- Explain how you determined Power and Interest for each stakeholder.
- Identify which stakeholder poses the greatest engagement challenge and why.
- Consider early warning signs of declining commitment, such as delayed responses or lack of participation.

Deliverables

- **Completed Stakeholder Engagement Plan (Excel Template)**

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